

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
5 FOR
6 HOUSE BILL NO. 3128

By: West (Kevin)

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10 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

11 An Act relating to labor; enacting the Actionable
12 Response for Industry Skills and Excellence in
13 Oklahoma Task Force (ARISE-OK); describing
14 legislative intent and purpose; defining terms;
15 creating guidelines for Task Force members; creating
16 guidelines for appointed members; describing duties;
17 requiring reports; describing report deadlines;
18 providing guidelines for compensation and
19 reimbursement; requiring staffing and support;
20 establishing sunset date; providing for
21 noncodification; providing for codification; and
22 providing an effective date.

23 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

24 SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law not to be
 codified in the Oklahoma Statutes reads as follows:

1 A. The Legislature finds that Oklahoma's long-term economic
2 growth, business competitiveness, and workforce capacity depend upon
3 strategic coordination between employers, education providers,
4 workforce systems, and state agencies.

5 B. It is the intent of the Legislature to:

- 6 1. Identify barriers to workforce entry and participation;
- 7 2. Strengthen workforce pipelines in key industries;
- 8 3. Align education and training systems with employer needs;
- 9 4. Support apprenticeships, technical training, and career
10 development;

11 5. Enhance Oklahoma's economic competitiveness through a
12 modernized, responsive workforce system; and

13 6. Ensure recommendations are industry-driven, data-informed,
14 and actionable.

15 SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
16 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 651 of Title 40, unless there is
17 created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

18 A. There is hereby created the Actionable Response for Industry
19 Skills and Excellence in Oklahoma Task Force (ARISE-OK).

20 B. The purpose of ARISE-OK is to evaluate statewide workforce
21 readiness, identify barriers to employment, strengthen workforce
22 pipelines, and advance strategies that support business growth and
23 economic competitiveness.

1 SECTION 3. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
2 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 652 of Title 40, unless there is
3 created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

4 For purposes of this act:

5 1. "Industry representative" means an individual employed by or
6 affiliated with a private-sector business operating within the State
7 of Oklahoma;

8 2. "Registered apprenticeship" means a program registered with
9 the United States Department of Labor or the Oklahoma Office of
10 Workforce Development;

11 3. "Task Force" or "ARISE-OK" means the Actionable Response for
12 Industry Skills and Excellence Task Force created by this act; and

13 4. "Workforce barriers" includes transportation, childcare,
14 credentialing, reentry, housing, and other obstacles preventing
15 workforce entry or retention.

16 SECTION 4. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
17 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 653 of Title 40, unless there is
18 created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

19 A. The Actionable Response for Industry Skills and Excellence
20 in Oklahoma Task Force (ARISE-OK) shall consist of the following
21 voting members:

22 1. The Commissioner of Labor, who shall serve as chair, or
23 designee;

1 2. The Executive Director of the Oklahoma Employment Security
2 Commission, or designee;

3 3. The Executive Director of the Oklahoma Department of
4 Commerce, or designee;

5 4. The State Director of Career and Technology Education, or
6 designee;

7 5. The Chancellor of The Oklahoma State System of Higher
8 Education, or designee; and

9 6. The Secretary of Agriculture, or designee.

10 B. The following shall serve as ex officio, nonvoting members:

11 1. The Executive Director of the Oklahoma Workforce Commission
12 (OWC), or designee;

13 2. The Executive Director of the Oklahoma Space Industry
14 Development Authority (OSIDA), or designee;

15 3. The Executive Director of the Oklahoma Center for the
16 Advancement of Science and Technology (OCAST), or designee;

17 4. One representative of the Oklahoma Tribal Finance Consortium
18 (OTFC); and

19 5. The Lieutenant Governor, or designee.

20 C. In addition, the Task Force shall include eleven (11)
21 appointed voting members as follows:

22 1. To be appointed by the Commissioner of Labor:

23 a. an apprenticeship or workforce training specialist,

24 b. a workforce training provider representative, and

1 c. a workforce barrier-reduction specialist;

2 2. To be appointed by the Governor:

3 a. an energy sector representative, and

4 b. a technology sector representative;

5 3. To be appointed by the Speaker of the Oklahoma House of
6 Representatives:

7 a. a construction sector representative,

8 b. a manufacturing sector representative, and

9 c. a veteran or military transition representative; and

10 4. To be appointed by the President Pro Tempore of the Oklahoma
11 State Senate:

12 a. an agriculture sector representative,

13 b. a health care sector representative, and

14 c. a statewide business or industry representative.

15 D. Members shall serve until the Task Force submits its final
16 report, unless replaced by the appointing authority. The appointing
17 authority has discretion to replace a member he or she appointed.

18 E. If any appointed member has not been selected by the
19 designated appointing authority within sixty (60) days of the
20 effective date of this act, the chair of the Task Force shall make
21 the appointment to fill the vacancy. Such appointment shall serve
22 until the appointing authority selects a member or until the Task
23 Force submits its final report, whichever occurs first.

1 SECTION 5. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
2 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 654 of Title 40, unless there is
3 created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

4 The Actionable Response for Industry Skills and Excellence in
5 Oklahoma Task Force (ARISE-OK) shall:

6 1. Evaluate Oklahoma's workforce readiness and talent shortages
7 across all industry sectors;

8 2. Identify regulatory, statutory, and practical barriers to
9 employment;

10 3. Recommend strategies to strengthen workforce training,
11 apprenticeships, career and technical education, education
12 alignment, and employer participation;

13 4. Study workforce challenges within agriculture,
14 manufacturing, energy, construction, health care, technology, and
15 veteran transition sectors;

16 5. Engage rural, urban, and veteran communities to ensure
17 statewide workforce responsiveness;

18 6. Coordinate studies and data requests within the Oklahoma
19 Workforce Commission to avoid duplication and ensure complementary
20 efforts;

21 7. Provide statutory and administrative recommendations to
22 improve workforce effectiveness and business competitiveness;
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1 8. Address workforce challenges not explicitly within the
2 Commission's statutory mission, including cross-sector coordination,
3 long-term strategic workforce policy, and structural barriers; and

4 9. Leverage expertise from ex officio members for emerging
5 industries and workforce insights.

6 SECTION 6. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
7 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 655 of Title 40, unless there is
8 created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

9 A. The Actionable Response for Industry Skills and Excellence
10 in Oklahoma Task Force (ARISE-OK) shall submit the following written
11 reports of findings and legislative recommendations, as follows:

- 12 1. Interim report by December 1, 2027;
- 13 2. Second report by December 1, 2028; and
- 14 3. Final report by December 1, 2029.

15 B. Each report shall be submitted to:

- 16 1. The Governor;
- 17 2. The President Pro Tempore of the Oklahoma State Senate;
- 18 3. The Speaker of the Oklahoma House of Representatives;
- 19 4. The Oklahoma Workforce Commission; and
- 20 5. The public via an online posting by the Department of Labor.

21 SECTION 7. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
22 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 656 of Title 40, unless there is
23 created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

1 A. Members of the Actionable Response for Industry Skills and
2 Excellence in Oklahoma Task Force (ARISE-OK) who are state employees
3 shall receive no additional compensation for duties performed under
4 this act.

5 B. Legislative or appointed members who are not state employees
6 may be reimbursed for necessary travel expenses in accordance with
7 the State Travel Reimbursement Act, subject to available funds.

8 C. No member shall receive a stipend or per diem for service on
9 the Task Force.

10 SECTION 8. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
11 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 657 of Title 40, unless there is
12 created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

13 The Department of Labor shall provide staff support, meeting
14 coordination, report posting, and administrative assistance to the
15 Actionable Response for Industry Skills and Excellence in Oklahoma
16 Task Force (ARISE-OK).

17 SECTION 9. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
18 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 658 of Title 40, unless there is
19 created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

20 A. The Actionable Response for Industry Skills and Excellence
21 in Oklahoma Task Force (ARISE-OK) shall terminate on December 31,
22 2029, unless continued by an act of the Legislature enacted no later
23 than the 2029 Regular Session.

1 B. Prior to termination, the Task Force shall submit its final
2 report, and the Legislature may extend, modify, or continue the Task
3 Force through subsequent legislation.

4 SECTION 10. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

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6 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON COMMER